AQE

AI Deployment Qualification Engine

Evidence Book · UK Jurisdiction

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This is the Evidence Book supporting Qualification Certificate AQE-C1EE1CFB. It contains the full findings, required actions, and question-by-question evidence behind that verdict. Keep it alongside the certificate.

Organisation	Northbridge Borough Council (fictional)
Reference	AQE-C1EE1CFB
Sector	Public Sector / Government
Jurisdiction	UK
Generated	17/10/2026
Classification	Confidential

01 Qualification Evidence

Findings are derived directly from intake responses. Each reflects a specific gap identified.

Findings reference regulatory frameworks to identify evidence gaps against named obligations. They are not legal advice and are not a determination that the organisation is in breach of any law or regulation. Independent legal advice should be sought before relying on this report for compliance purposes.

Data Readiness: CONDITIONAL

Qualification gaps

- Data assets are partially identified. Gaps in coverage will limit AI scope.
- Mix of structured and unstructured data. Structuring effort needed for target use cases.
- Partial cloud migration or mixed storage. Accessibility is constrained.
- Data quality is inconsistent. Monitoring and validation required before AI deployment.
- No data lineage documentation. It is unclear which data feeds which system or model. This is a governance risk.

Required before Full Qualification

- Document data lineage for the datasets in scope, so provenance is traceable before AI use.
- Complete the data asset inventory, prioritising the datasets that would feed any AI use case.
- Classify the data in scope and bring the key unstructured sources into a structured, queryable form.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 5 questions in this area, averaging 4.8 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

Process Maturity: CONDITIONAL

Qualification gaps

- Some repetitive processes exist but are not fully mapped.
- Some decision patterns exist but criteria are inconsistent.
- Bottlenecks are known but not quantified.
- Criteria are partially consistent. Some standardisation required.
- Some automation attempted with mixed results. Lessons available.

Required before Full Qualification

- Map and document the processes the AI would support, so they can be followed without relying on individuals.
- Define the decision rules within those processes so the same inputs lead to the same outcome.

- Identify and quantify the process bottlenecks so AI scope and success measures can be set.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 5 questions in this area, averaging 5.2 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

Tooling & Infrastructure: CONDITIONAL

Qualification gaps

- Modern tools exist but integration gaps limit AI potential.
- Informal or vendor AI tools in use. Governance of existing use is needed.
- No oversight controls cover AI tool use, current or future. Any informal (shadow) AI use would be ungoverned.
- Partial integration. Manual data transfers in use.
- Some legacy constraints. Workarounds are available but add cost.

Required before Full Qualification

- Put documented governance and oversight in place for all AI tool use, formal or informal.
- Modernise or connect the parts of the technology stack the AI deployment depends on.
- Record where AI tools are, or will be, used, including informal use by staff.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 5 questions in this area, averaging 4.4 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

People & Capability: CONDITIONAL

Qualification gaps

- Awareness exists but capability to act is limited.
- No AI ownership exists. Without a named owner, governance cannot function.
- Leadership interest but no formal mandate or budget.
- No AI training has taken place. Staff operating AI tools without understanding limitations or risk.

Required before Full Qualification

- Assign a named accountable owner for AI, with a defined escalation path.
- Put AI literacy training in place for staff who use, or will use, AI tools.
- Build AI awareness and capability in the teams that will oversee the AI system.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 4 questions in this area, averaging 4.0 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

Governance & Compliance: DEFICIENT

Qualification gaps

- Regulations are known but compliance mapping is incomplete.
- Automated decisions exist but oversight is partial.
- Some policies exist but are not comprehensive or current.
- No DPIA conducted. Typically required under UK GDPR Article 35 for high-risk processing. This is flagged as a priority evidence gap. The absence of a DPIA is an area where the ICO has shown enforcement interest.
- No ability to evidence responsible AI use. Regulator-ready posture is absent.

Required before Full Qualification

- Immediate: AI governance framework design and implementation.
- DPIA on all live automated decision processes.
- Regulatory mapping: UK GDPR, EU AI Act classification.

Qualification impact: Must be fixed first; holds back full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 5 questions in this area, averaging 3.2 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

02 Required Actions Before Full Qualification

Actions are sequenced by severity. Areas rated Deficient must be addressed first.

Governance & Compliance

1	Immediate: AI governance framework design and implementation.
2	DPIA on all live automated decision processes.
3	Regulatory mapping: UK GDPR, EU AI Act classification.

Data Readiness

4	Document data lineage for the datasets in scope, so provenance is traceable before AI use.
5	Complete the data asset inventory, prioritising the datasets that would feed any AI use case.
6	Classify the data in scope and bring the key unstructured sources into a structured, queryable form.

Process Maturity

7	Map and document the processes the AI would support, so they can be followed without relying on individuals.
8	Define the decision rules within those processes so the same inputs lead to the same outcome.
9	Identify and quantify the process bottlenecks so AI scope and success measures can be set.

Tooling & Infrastructure

10	Put documented governance and oversight in place for all AI tool use, formal or informal.
11	Modernise or connect the parts of the technology stack the AI deployment depends on.
12	Record where AI tools are, or will be, used, including informal use by staff.

People & Capability

13	Assign a named accountable owner for AI, with a defined escalation path.
14	Put AI literacy training in place for staff who use, or will use, AI tools.
15	Build AI awareness and capability in the teams that will oversee the AI system.

03 What Happens Next

This deployment is qualified to proceed, subject to the conditions listed above. Complete those actions, then request a reassessment. A new certificate will be issued confirming full qualification once they're met.

Priority areas identified by client: Customer services; housing and council tax enquiries

04 Qualification Obligations

Material governance exposure identified. Live AI use without documented controls creates direct regulatory risk under UK GDPR Article 22 (automated decisions), Article 35 (DPIA requirement), and likely Annex III high-risk classification under the EU AI Act. Formal governance engagement is required before further AI deployment.

Obligation	Relevance	Status
UK GDPR Article 22	Automated decision-making affecting individuals	GAP
UK GDPR Article 35	DPIA required for high-risk AI processing	GAP
FCA Consumer Duty	AI outputs must demonstrably serve customer interests	NOT APPLICABLE
EU AI Act Annex III	High-risk classification assessment	UNASSESSED

This report was produced using the AI Qualification Engine (AQE). Findings are consistent for the same inputs. This report does not constitute legal or regulatory advice.

This page explains how the Deployment Exposure and Deployment Control scores on the Qualification Decision page were derived.

Deployment Exposure (0-100)

Derived from the decision class this system operates in (informational through fully autonomous), the scale of deployment (single team through enterprise-wide), and the number of deployment-blocking governance signals identified elsewhere in this report. Higher autonomy, wider scale, and more blocking signals increase the score.

Deployment Control (0-100)

Derived from whether a named accountable owner is confirmed, whether that owner holds authority to stop or delay the deployment unilaterally, and whether the deployment has confirmed board or senior-level visibility. Absence of a named owner caps this score regardless of the other factors.

Governance & Compliance override

A Governance & Compliance rating of Deficient combined with high deployment exposure results in Not Qualified regardless of the scores above. Combined with low exposure, it caps the outcome at Qualified with Conditions.

Thresholds and reproducibility

Thresholds and scoring weights are fixed for a given framework version and do not vary between runs, between organisations, or over time. The same inputs assessed against the same framework version will always reproduce the same scores and the same verdict.